

MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Welcome, and How to Use This Course

What AIP-C01 tests, why the official service list is out of date, and how to study this.

EXAM AIP-C01 LEVEL Professional MODULE 0 of 22

This is a **service selection** exam wearing a developer's clothes. You are not asked to write code. You are asked which AWS building blocks to assemble, and why not the other three.

This certification is aimed at you if

- ◆ You already build with foundation models and want AWS-specific validation.
- ◆ You work with Bedrock, vector stores or agents and want the credential to match.
- ◆ AWS expects **two or more years** building production applications, plus **one year** hands-on with generative AI.
- ◆ There are **no formal prerequisites**. You may sit this without any other AWS certification.
- ◆ This is not an entry point. If generative AI is new to you, sit AI Practitioner first.

ON THE EXAM

AWS suggests AI Practitioner, Solutions Architect Associate, Machine Learning Engineer Associate or Data Engineer Associate as useful groundwork. None is required.

What exam day looks like

DETAIL

Duration	180 minutes
Questions	75 total. 65 are scored, 10 are unscored and unmarked
Formats	Multiple choice, and multiple response with two or more correct from five or more
Passing score	750 out of 1000, on a scaled model
Scoring	Compensatory. You pass overall, not each domain
Cost	300 US dollars
Delivery	Pearson VUE test centre, or online proctored

ON THE EXAM

180 minutes across 75 questions is 2 minutes 24 seconds each. On scenarios this long, that is tight. Module 19 covers the time strategy.

The five domains and their published weights

DOMAIN	WEIGHT	ROUGHLY
1. Foundation Model Integration, Data Management, and Compliance	31%	20 questions
2. Implementation and Integration	26%	17 questions
3. AI Safety, Security, and Governance	20%	13 questions
4. Operational Efficiency and Optimization	12%	8 questions
5. Testing, Validation, and Troubleshooting	11%	7 questions

ON THE EXAM

Domains 1 and 2 are 57% between them. If you are short on time, that is where it goes.

LEAST operational overhead is the most important phrase on this exam. It appears constantly, and it almost always means: choose the managed service, not the thing you build yourself.

The exam guide is behind the service catalogue

- ◆ On **30 June 2026** AWS moved around twenty AI services and features into maintenance mode.
- ◆ **Kendra, Q Business, Bedrock Agents** and ten SageMaker AI features closed to new customers in late July 2026.
- ◆ **Every one of them is still named in the official in-scope services list.**
- ◆ This course teaches them as examinable, and flags the reality each time it comes up.
- ◆ Nothing was switched off. Existing workloads keep running and keep getting security fixes.

ON THE EXAM

If you study only from current AWS documentation you will be baffled by questions about services you cannot sign up for. This is why.

Frozen in June 2026, still on the exam

SERVICE	WHAT HAPPENED	THE SUCCESSOR AWS NAMES
Bedrock Agents	Renamed Agents Classic, closed 30 Jul 2026	Bedrock AgentCore
Amazon Kendra	Maintenance 30 Jun, closed 30 Jul 2026	Bedrock Knowledge Bases
Amazon Q Business	Closed to new customers 31 Jul 2026	Amazon Quick
SageMaker Clarify	Maintenance from 30 Jun 2026	No direct replacement named
SageMaker Model Monitor	Maintenance from 30 Jun 2026	No direct replacement named
SageMaker Ground Truth	Maintenance from 30 Jun 2026	No direct replacement named
Amazon Augmented AI	Maintenance from 30 Jun 2026	No direct replacement named

ON THE EXAM

Learn both columns. The left one answers exam questions today. The right one answers them in a year, and answers your actual job now.

Two hats, and you need both

SITTING THE EXAM

Answer from the catalogue

- If Kendra fits the requirement, pick Kendra
- Question banks lag service changes by a year
- Maintenance mode is invisible to the exam writer
- Never argue yourself out of a right answer

DOING THE JOB

Build on what is still open

- New projects go to Knowledge Bases, AgentCore and Quick
- Agents Classic freezes out of future model access
- Migration is a real project, not a config change
- Existing workloads have no forced deadline

THE TIEBREAKER

Answer the question that was asked, not the one your production experience wishes had been asked.

What makes a Professional paper different

- ◆ Scenarios run **three or four paragraphs**. Associate exams give you two sentences.
- ◆ Multiple constraints per question, and **all** of them must be satisfied by your answer.
- ◆ Usually two options are clearly wrong and **two are both defensible**. One violates a constraint you skimmed.
- ◆ Multiple response is all or nothing. Four right out of five correct answers scores zero.
- ◆ The deciding detail is almost always in the **last sentence** before the question.

ON THE EXAM

The skill this exam rewards is careful reading under time pressure. That is trainable, and Module 19 trains it directly.

How a worked scenario runs in this course

01

Situation

A business scenario appears with four options and a pause marker.

02

Pause

Stop the video. Commit to an answer out loud or on paper.

03

Walkthrough

Every option gets a reason, including the three wrong ones.

04

The signal

An amber bar names the detail in the scenario that decided it.

ON THE EXAM

The wrong answers are where the teaching is. Knowing why B fails generalises to questions you have never seen. Knowing that C is correct does not.

The pause is not optional

- ◆ Watching a walkthrough without answering first **feels productive and teaches almost nothing**.
- ◆ Being wrong and finding out why is the mechanism. Comfort is not.
- ◆ Write your answer down. Recognising the right answer once revealed is not the same as choosing it.
- ◆ In the three practice exams the pause is held for **nine seconds**, so they run as timed practice.
- ◆ Note **why** you picked wrong, not just that you did. The pattern in your errors is the useful data.

ON THE EXAM

If you take one thing from this module, take this one.

The course at a glance

MODULES	WHAT THEY COVER	RUNTIME
00	This introduction	11 min
01 to 06	Domain 1. Model selection, customisation, data pipelines, vector stores, retrieval, prompts	136 min
07 to 10	Domain 2. Agents, FM APIs, deployment, enterprise integration and CI/CD	89 min
11 to 13	Domain 3. Guardrails, data security, governance and responsible AI	64 min
14 to 15	Domain 4. Cost, performance, monitoring and observability	41 min
16 to 17	Domain 5. Evaluation and troubleshooting	41 min
18 to 19	Confusion pairs, then exam mechanics and question strategy	45 min
20 to 22	Three practice exams, 25 questions each	123 min

ON THE EXAM

Twenty three modules, nine hours and a quarter. Module time follows the domain weights, not what is easiest to explain.

A route, not just a contents list

- ◆ **Watch in order.** Later modules assume vocabulary the earlier ones establish.
- ◆ After module 17, sit **practice exam one**. Then note which domain your wrong answers cluster in.
- ◆ Rewatch **only** that domain. Then modules 18 and 19, then exams two and three on separate days.
- ◆ Revising what you already know feels great, scores well, and moves nothing.
- ◆ Get hands on Bedrock alongside this. Ten hours of video does not replace building one RAG pipeline.

ON THE EXAM

Which domain your misses cluster in matters far more than your practice score.

Where this course's content comes from

- ◆ **Every scenario here is original.** Nothing is copied from any question bank.
- ◆ A bank of practice questions was analysed only to learn which decisions the exam tests, and how often.
- ◆ That analysis set where the time goes. Not one question from it appears in this course.
- ◆ Every explanation is sourced from **official AWS documentation** and the published exam guide.
- ◆ Memorising a leaked question teaches you that question. Understanding the decision teaches you fifty you have not seen.

ON THE EXAM

Service availability changes fast. Check the live exam guide before your test date, and treat anything here dated after early 2026 as worth re-verifying.

Module 1 starts where the exam starts: a business requirement, a catalogue of foundation models, and the question of **which one, and how do you call it.**